

Ernest SONG ♦ Finance Domain Leader

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Finance leader with 15+ years leading accounting and transformation mandates for multi-entity, multi-country organisations across BE, FR and NL. I specialise in General Accounting (GL, AP, AR) and financial-close leadership, and in guiding ERP replacements from AS-IS diagnosis to SAP S/4HANA go-live. What sets me apart is perspective: I've sat on both the operator's and the executive-recruiter's side of the table, so I read the numbers and the organisation behind them. I bring calm under pressure, rigorous Power BI / Cognos reporting, and a genuine commitment to turning finance into a lever for growth.

Education

ESCP Business School

(#1 FT 2026)

2010 – 2011 | Paris, FR

Specialized Master's degree

Auditing and Consulting

Université Paris Nanterre

2005 – 2010 | Paris, FR

Master's degree

Management Science and Financial Control

Competencies

Business

- MS Office (advanced Excel, Power Query)

ERP

- SAP HANA

Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- QlikSense
- Business Object
- Cognos
- Hyperion

RPA

- UiPath
- MS PowerAutomate

Agile

- Jira
- Confluence

Data & Analytics

- VBA
- SQL
- R

Data & Analytics

- VBA
- SQL
- R

Languages

Native: French, Khmer, Teochew

Proficient: English

Basics: Dutch (A2), Spanish, Mandarin

Interests

Sustainable development, Powerlifting, Mountain biking, Tennis

Interpersonal

Fast-learner, Problem solver, Diplomacy, Driven, Autonomous, Teamplayer

Professional Experience

Engie SEM

January 2026 – Present | Brussels, BE

Strategic Business Analyst & Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)

- Led month-end/year-end GL close for up to 6 BE/FR/NL entities (ERP replacing legacy AS/400), strengthening financial-close control across the multi-entity group.
- Drove AS-IS to TO-BE process design for finance sub-processes, coordinating cross-functional workshops and stakeholder sign-off.
- Automated the financial close with PowerQuery ETL, ingesting 1,500+ bookings per close with zero manual intervention.
- Trained end-users on Infor M3 and validated UAT for finance sub-processes before go-live, documenting steering-committee sign-off.

Holcim

January 2024 – December 2025 | Nivelles, BE

Senior Operational Excellence & Data Lead (Freelancer)

- Managed the SAP HANA ERP data migration, restructuring data and preserving system integrity.
- Rolled out Qlik Sense finance reporting, building 8 executive dashboards that shortened reporting cycles by 50% and enabled faster, evidence-based managerial decisions.
- Built rebate models (matrix & automated SAP) aligned to commercial strategy, driving €150M annual rebate volume with 99.8% accuracy and resolving commercial disputes 30% faster.
- Guaranteed data reliability and partnered with auditors on rebate matters.

Engie Tractebel

March 2023 – December 2023 | Brussels, BE

Cash Flow & Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer)

- Designed cash-flow reporting and per-project financing-need assessment.
- Assessed local financing needs, performed countercredit analysis, and conducted impairment testing.
- Engineered finance data models from SAP HANA, delivering 8 Power BI executive dashboards that turned raw transactions into decision-ready insights for finance leadership.

Shurgard

February 2022 – February 2023 | Brussels, BE

Freelance M&A / Corporate Development Consultant

- Advised on self-storage M&A transactions worth €10M to €80M, structuring and negotiating acquisitions, restructurings, and divestitures.
- Maintained project dashboard and initiated corporate development projects to improve department policies and procedures.
- Designed the data model and visualization for the Investment department's Business Intelligence efforts.
- Collaborated in the development of a new pricing model using Artificial Intelligence.

Magnetrap

November 2020 – January 2022 | Mons, BE

Freelance CFO / Fundraising Consultant

- Acted as interim CFO and led fundraising, organizing €3M in debt/equity fund raises.
- Produced cash-flow projections, business plans, and long-term financial goals.
- Monitored company performance and drove corrective actions.
- Prepared operating results reports and maintained financial models for long-term use.

Tobania

February 2020 – October 2020 | Brussels, BE

Director Business Process Automation

- Led development and implementation of citizen developer business model using RPA and self-service BI, including pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Managed business development, including marketing strategy, pre-sales, and sales, and identified new business opportunities.
- Implemented process optimization, standardization, and harmonization to improve efficiency and profitability for customers.
- Provided regular, tailored reports to help customers monitor and control costs and make data-driven business decisions, and established change management structures and strategies to facilitate successful adoption of new processes and technologies.

Soap collect

January 2019 – Present | Phnom Penh, KH

Founder

- Established a non-profit organization focused on providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Formed partnerships with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.

Degroof Petercam

January 2018 – December 2018 | Brussels, BE

Performance Management Project Leader

- Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM)
- Designed and implemented a client-centric performance management system.
- Optimized finance close process for improved governance, internal control, and data quality.
- Led projects related to regulatory reporting sourcing and followed BPM standards.
- Conducted gap analysis of business requirements and existing procedures to identify areas for improvement.

Vinci Airports

February 2016 – December 2017 | Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT

Freelance Business Development & Financial Modeling Director

- Led the group's subsidiaries, contributing to a €12B valuation.
- Led deployment of airport operations at 50+ locations in various countries.
- Developed long-term financial business model including analysis of macroeconomic impact, capital expenditures, and concession valuation.
- Negotiated extension of concession contract with Portuguese authorities and implemented new financial business model to improve budgeting and forecasting processes.
- Managed accounting and financial reporting in accordance with BE-GAAP standards.

Rexel

September 2014 – January 2016 | Paris, FR

Freelance Finance Consolidation & Reporting Consultant

- Managed consolidated reporting across a €3B-turnover scope spanning LATAM, APAC, and Canada, aligning GL/AP/AR flows for strong financial-close control.
- Integrated SAP BPC and Cognos reporting, strengthening GL/AP consolidated reporting.
- Ran annual budgeting and monthly forecasting (actual vs. budget).

KPMG Audit

January 2011 – August 2014 | Paris, FR

Financial Auditor Supervisor

- Audited financial statements under multiple accounting standards (BE-GAAP, SOX), strengthening GL and financial-close controls.
- Audited financial modelling for long-term PPP contracts.
- Certified FP7 grant agreements; led audit teams and supervised auditors.

ICM - Brain & Spine Institute

November 2009 – August 2010 | Paris, FR

Deputy CFO Trainee

- Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams.
- Established the internal control system for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation.
- Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the "Comité de la Charte".